

Product Specification: "Choose Your Preview"

Product: Mapping With Melanin App

Feature: Choose Your Preview

Status: Pre-Development (Pending App Store Approval Build 101)

Target Launch: Phase 1 (Web) prior to 8/15 National Tour

1. Feature Overview

What It Is:

"Choose Your Preview" is an interactive onboarding and waitlist-engagement feature. Rather than a static landing page or standard app walkthrough, users are invited to select which aspect of the Mapping With Melanin platform matters most to them. Upon selection, they receive a tailored, high-fidelity preview of that specific feature before being prompted to join the waitlist or sign up.

Why It Matters:

This feature was inspired by the founder's daughter and leans heavily into the core brand ethos of community empowerment and urgent necessity ("I wish I had this last year, I need it today"). It transforms passive waiting into active investment in the platform's vision.

The Dual Purpose:

1. **Emotional Engagement:** It builds immediate trust and anticipation by showing users exactly how the app solves their specific pain points (safety, discovery, business growth, or community connection).
 2. **Investor-Ready Data:** It acts as a powerful intent-capture mechanism. By tracking which previews users select, the company generates real-time, quantifiable data on user priorities and product-market fit—crucial metrics for the upcoming national tour and investor pitches.
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2. User Flow

Phase 1: Website Flow (Pre-App Store Approval)

1. **Entry Point:** User scans QR code at national tour event or clicks a social link.

2. **Landing Page (/preview):** User lands on a mobile-optimized page displaying the "Choose Your Preview" prompt with 4 distinct cards.
3. **Selection:** User taps one of the 4 cards.
4. **The Preview:** The screen transitions to a high-fidelity, interactive mockup of the selected app feature, accompanied by emotionally resonant copy.
5. **Call to Action:** A sticky button at the bottom prompts: "Join the Waitlist to Get Access First."
6. **Conversion:** User enters their email/phone number.
7. **Confirmation:** User receives a culturally resonant thank-you message confirming their spot and preview choice.

Phase 2: In-App Flow (Post-App Store Approval)

1. **Entry Point:** User downloads the app and opens it for the first time (non-logged-in state).
 2. **Onboarding Screen:** Instead of a standard swipe-through tutorial, the user sees the 4 preview cards.
 3. **Selection:** User taps a card.
 4. **The Preview:** User experiences a guided, restricted-access view of the actual app interface tailored to their choice.
 5. **Call to Action:** "Create Account to Unlock."
 6. **Conversion:** User completes the signup process.
 7. **Personalization (Phase 3):** The user's feed and default map view are personalized based on their initial selection.
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3. Preview Options (The 4 Cards)

A) Safety

- **Card Title:** Keep My People Safe
- **Subtitle:** Navigate with confidence and awareness.
- **Emotional Hook / Tagline:** "Because our peace of mind shouldn't be a luxury. Know before you go."
- **Preview Screen Content:** A map interface highlighting a safe route. Red warning zones indicate historical sundown towns. Green checkmarks show community-verified safe

spaces. A push notification mockup reads: *"Community Alert: Heavy police presence reported near 4th & Main. Rerouting suggested."*

- **Sample Data/Text:** "Verified Safe Space: The Book & Bean Cafe." "Historical Context: Sundown Town Warning - Proceed with caution after dusk."
- **Evoked Feeling:** Security, solidarity, protection, and collective vigilance.

B) Business Discovery

- **Card Title:** Find Trusted Businesses
- **Subtitle:** Spend where you are celebrated.
- **Emotional Hook / Tagline:** "Keep our dollars in our community. Discover the gems in your backyard."
- **Preview Screen Content:** A rich directory view featuring high-quality images of diverse, minority-owned businesses. Badges indicate specific ownership (e.g., Black-owned, Indigenous-owned, Woman-owned). A map view shows clusters of businesses with custom pins.
- **Sample Data/Text:** "Taste of the Caribbean - 4.9 Stars (120 Community Reviews)." "Ownership Badge: Afro-Latino Owned." "Vibe Check: Welcoming, Family-Friendly."
- **Evoked Feeling:** Pride, economic empowerment, excitement, and cultural connection.

C) Business Owner

- **Card Title:** I Own a Business
- **Subtitle:** Grow your legacy with a loyal community.
- **Emotional Hook / Tagline:** "Stop fighting algorithms. Connect directly with the people looking for you."
- **Preview Screen Content:** A clean, data-rich dashboard. Charts showing profile views and foot traffic driven by the app. A quick-action button to "Broadcast a Flash Deal."
- **Sample Data/Text:** "Your Profile was viewed 342 times this week." "Flash Deal Active: 15% off for the next 2 hours." "Customer Feedback: 'So glad I found this place on the app!'"
- **Evoked Feeling:** Control, growth, validation, and relief from marketing fatigue.

D) Community Connection

- **Card Title:** Connect With Community
- **Subtitle:** Find your tribe, honor your roots.

- **Emotional Hook / Tagline:** "More than a map—it's our digital village. Welcome home."
 - **Preview Screen Content:** A social feed of community posts and upcoming local events. A map filter toggled to "Cultural Heritage Sites" and "HBCUs," showing rich historical markers and alumni networking hubs.
 - **Sample Data/Text:** "Event: First Friday Black Art Walk." "Historical Site: Madam C.J. Walker Villa Lewaro." "HBCU Connect: Spelman Alumni Meetup Tonight."
 - **Evoked Feeling:** Belonging, nostalgia, cultural pride, and rootedness.
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4. Data Tracking & Analytics

Database Schema Updates:

The `waitlist` (and eventually `users`) table requires a new column to store the user's intent.

- `preview_choice` : ENUM ('safety', 'discovery', 'business', 'community')

Investor Analytics Dashboard:

To support the national tour and investor pitches, a simple admin dashboard should aggregate this data in real-time.

- **Total Scans/Visits:** Tracked via the QR code UTM parameters.
- **Choice Distribution:** A pie chart showing the percentage breakdown of the 4 choices (e.g., "72% chose Safety as their top interest").
- **Conversion Rate by Choice:** Which preview drives the highest waitlist completion rate?
- **Time on Preview:** How long users spend looking at the preview screen before signing up.

Investor Framing: "We don't just have a waitlist; we have a quantified breakdown of our community's most urgent needs. 72% of our users are demanding the Safety features, proving immediate product-market fit for our core differentiator."

5. Copy & Messaging

Selection Screen Header:

What brings you to the map?

Selection Screen Subheader:

Choose your preview and see how Mapping With Melanin is built for you.

Card Front-Facing Text:

See Section 3 for Titles and Subtitles.

Call-To-Action (CTA) Buttons:

- On Selection Screen: *Cards act as buttons.*
- On Preview Screen: **"I Need This Today — Join the Waitlist"**
- On Business Owner Preview: **"Claim My Business — Join the Waitlist"**

Post-Selection Confirmation Message:

You're on the list, family.

We're building this for us, by us. We'll notify you the second your city goes live. Until then, keep the community strong.

The Emotional Arc:

1. **Curiosity (QR Scan):** "What is this?"
2. **Agency (Selection):** "They care about what I want."
3. **Urgency (Preview):** "I wish I had this last year. I need it today."
4. **Commitment (Signup):** "I'm part of this movement."

6. Design Guidance

- **Color Palette:**
 - Primary Background: Deep, rich dark brown (#2B1507)
 - Accents & Highlights: Warm gold (#CA922B)
 - Text: Off-white/cream for readability against dark backgrounds.
- **Typography:**
 - Headers & Display Text: **Playfair Display** (evokes heritage, elegance, and trust).
 - Body & UI Text: **Inter** (clean, modern, highly legible on mobile).
- **Layout (Mobile-First):**
 - The 4 cards should be displayed in a 2x2 grid on standard mobile screens, or a vertical stack on smaller devices.
 - Cards should have subtle gold borders that illuminate upon selection.
 - The preview screens should use high-quality, realistic UI mockups that feel like a native app experience, even on the web.
- **Animations:** Smooth, intentional transitions. When a card is tapped, it should expand to fill the screen, revealing the preview content.

7. Technical Implementation (Replit-Ready)

1. Database Update (Prisma/SQL):

SQL

```
ALTER TABLE waitlist ADD COLUMN preview_choice VARCHAR(50);  
-- Valid values: 'safety', 'discovery', 'business', 'community'
```

2. API Endpoint Update (POST /api/waitlist):

Ensure the endpoint accepts and validates the new field.

JavaScript

```
// Example Next.js / Express handler update  
const { email, phone, preview_choice } = req.body;  
if (!['safety', 'discovery', 'business', 'community'].includes(preview_choice))  
  return res.status(400).json({ error: "Invalid preview choice" });  
}  
// Insert into database...
```

3. Web Implementation (mappingwithmelanin.com/preview):

- Build as a standalone React/Next.js page.
- Use state to manage the current view ('selection' -> 'preview' -> 'signup' -> 'success').
- Ensure UTM parameters from the QR code are passed through to the waitlist submission for tracking tour effectiveness.

4. Mobile Implementation (Post-Approval):

- Create a PreviewSelector component in React Native/Expo.
- Inject this screen into the initial onboarding stack before the SignUp screen.

5. Analytics Tracking:

- Implement basic event tracking (e.g., PostHog, Mixpanel, or custom DB logging).
- Events to track: preview_viewed , preview_selected , waitlist_joined .

8. Timeline & Phasing

Phase 1: Web-Only Launch (Target: Before 8/15)

- **Focus:** Build the standalone web page (/preview) and update the waitlist API.

- **Goal:** Have the QR codes ready for the founder's national tour starting 8/15.
- **Deliverable:** Fully functional mobile web experience to capture intent and emails.

Phase 2: In-App Integration (Target: Post-App Store Approval)

- **Focus:** Replicate the web experience as the native app onboarding flow.
- **Goal:** Engage organic App Store downloads immediately upon opening the app.
- **Deliverable:** App update (Build 102+) replacing standard onboarding with the Preview Selector.

Phase 3: Personalized Experience (Target: Post-Launch Optimization)

- **Focus:** Tie the user's preview choice to their actual app account.
 - **Goal:** If a user selected "Safety," their default map view upon logging in prioritizes safety alerts. If they selected "Business," they default to the directory.
 - **Deliverable:** Dynamic feed and map rendering based on user profile preferences.
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9. Investor Value & Pitch Deck Framing

This feature is not just a UX improvement; it is a proprietary data engine.

How to Present in a Pitch Deck:

- **Slide Title:** "Validating the Demand: Community-Driven Data"
- **The Metric:** "During our national tour, X,XXX users joined our waitlist via QR scan."
- **The Insight:** "Because we allow users to 'Choose Their Preview,' we know exactly why they are joining. 72% of our waitlist selected 'Keep My People Safe' as their primary interest."
- **The Conclusion:** "This proves that Mapping With Melanin is not just another directory app. We are solving an urgent, emotional need for physical and psychological safety—a need that no mainstream mapping platform is currently addressing for our demographic. We have the data to prove the demand exists *before* we even launch."